Jenkins Orthopedic Surgery & Spine Center 123 Medical Plaza, Suite 400, New York, NY 10001 Date: October 16, 2026

To: AmeriHealth / Q-Care Affordable Medical Care Department: Appeals and Reconsiderations Patient Name: John Doe Member ID: AMH-987654321 Date of Service: September 28, 2026 Claim Number: CLM-2026-889012 Requested Procedure: MRI Lumbar Spine without contrast (CPT 72148)

Subject: Reconsideration Request / First Level Appeal for Denied MRI

To Whom It May Concern:

I am writing to formally request a reconsideration of the denied authorization for a Lumbar Spine MRI for my patient, Mr. John Doe. The initial claim was denied on October 2, 2026, stating that "failure of conservative therapy was not adequately documented" per policy AMH-RAD-2026.

I am appealing this decision because the criteria for Section I.B (Failure of Conservative Therapy) have been fully met.

Mr. Doe has been under my care for severe, radiating lower back pain that extends down his right leg (sciatica). As per your clinical guidelines, Mr. Doe completed a rigorous eight (8) week course of physical therapy at Apex Rehab from July 15, 2026, through September 10, 2026 (attending twice weekly). Additionally, he has been on a continuous regimen of Naproxen (500mg BID) and Cyclobenzaprine (10mg at night) during this entire duration.

Unfortunately, Mr. Doe has experienced no symptomatic relief; in fact, his radicular pain has worsened, limiting his ability to ambulate.

It appears the original physical therapy flowsheets were omitted in the initial prior authorization submission by our administrative staff. I have attached the complete physical therapy logs and my clinical notes detailing his pharmacological regimen to this appeal.

Based on this documentation, Mr. Doe strictly meets the six-week conservative therapy requirement. I urgently request that this denial be overturned and the MRI authorized so we can properly diagnose the extent of his nerve root compression.

Sincerely,

Dr. Sarah Jenkins, MD Board Certified Orthopedic Surgeon Jenkins Orthopedic Surgery & Spine Center